

WHITE TEA

Produced mostly in China's Fujian province, white tea is the least processed of all teas. However, it takes a long time to produce (2-3 days), and has a slight natural oxidation from its long withering process (about 2 days), after which it is baked at a low heat, sorted, and baked again. There are several types of white tea. Some are made from leaves and buds so tender they still have a fine white fuzz, or "pekoe," on them; others use larger leaves and are a little more oxidized. White tea is considered one of the healthiest teas, as it contains antioxidants, such as catechins and polyphenols, concentrated in the bud that help strengthen the immune system.

Bai Hao Yin Zhen

Fujian province, China

Bai Mu Dan

Fujian province, China

Shou Mei

Fujian province, China

Da Hong Pao

Fujian province, China

Tie Guan Yin

Fujian province, China

OOLONG TEA

Oolong is also produced in China's Fujian province, especially in the Wuyi Mountains, and on Taiwan's mountainsides. This semi-oxidized tea uses mature leaves that undergo a rigorous production process. They are withered for a few hours, then "rattled" or shaken to bruise the leaves and destroy the cell walls to aid flavor release during oxidation. The oxidation process can go on for hours, until the tea master decides that the tea has reached the correct level of oxidation. The leaves are then fired to prevent further oxidation, rolled, and then fired again, or roasted. Lightly oxidized oolongs are shaped into small, shiny, dark-green pellets, while the more heavily oxidized oolongs become long, dark, twisted leaves.